

- ↔ 22–24 in (56–61 cm)
- ⚖ 18–30 oz (510–850 g)
- ⊗ Common
- 🍌 Fruit, eggs, insects, frogs
- 🏠



#### △ STRONG FLIGHT

Long, wide wings and powerful chest muscles help the scarlet macaw speed through the air, aided by its flexible tail.

# Scarlet macaw

*Ara macao*

Macaws are huge parrots with long tails and massive bills. The scarlet macaw—one of the largest members of this group—is a native of humid tropical forests. It lives in the dense tree canopy and communicates with far-carrying, ear-splitting screeches.

Scarlet macaws typically live in pairs—they pair for life—but often assemble in noisy groups, resting in tall trees. They eat nuts and seeds, cracking open tough shells with their powerful bills, as well as fruit, flowers, and leaves. Large flocks gather at vertical clay cliffs, where they scrape up the soil with their tongues. The minerals help to neutralize toxins in their food that would be fatal to most birds. In the wild, scarlet macaws can live for 50 years.

- ↔ 33–35 in (84–89 cm)
- ⚖ 2–3 lb (0.9–1.4 kg)
- ⊗ Common
- 🍌 Nuts, seeds, fruit
- 🏠

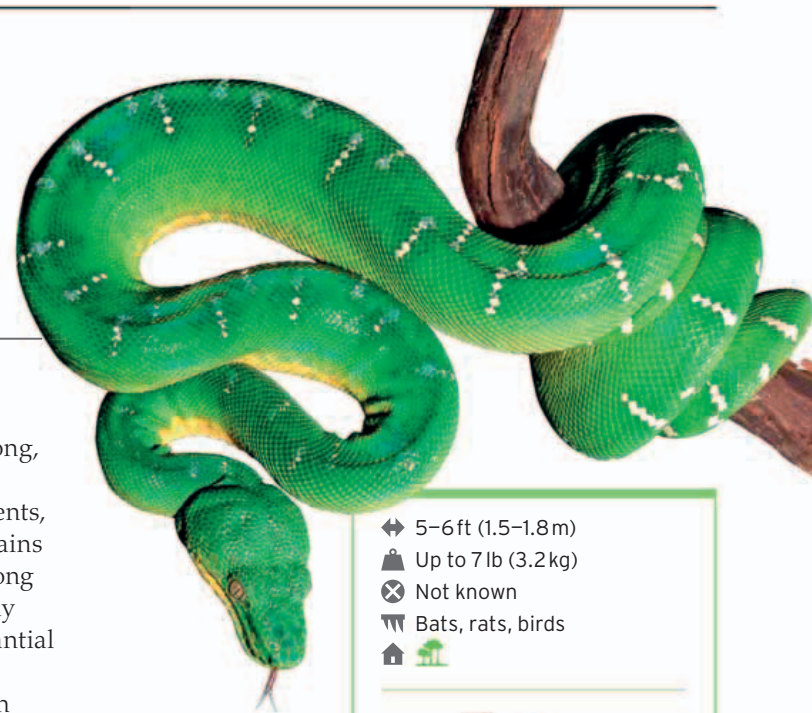


# Emerald tree boa

*Corallus caninus*

Well camouflaged among fresh green foliage, this nonvenomous tree boa has a wide head, powerful jaws, and very long, curved teeth. These are used to grab passing prey such as bats, arboreal rodents, lizards, and birds, while the snake remains securely anchored to a branch by its strong prehensile tail. Small victims are quickly swallowed whole, whereas more substantial prey is first suffocated by constriction.

Male emerald tree boas mature when three or four years old. They are slightly smaller and slimmer than females, which mature a year later. Mating occurs between May and July, and the female gives birth to 5–20 live young six months later. The baby boas are red or orange in color, changing to green after about a year. There is no parental care.



- ↔ 5–6 ft (1.5–1.8 m)
- ⚖ Up to 7 lb (3.2 kg)
- ⊗ Not known
- 🍌 Bats, rats, birds
- 🏠



#### △ READY TO STRIKE

The emerald tree boa strikes out at airborne prey or hangs from a low branch to snatch its victim from the ground.